



From Cotton Boll to Fiber

OBSERVE • EXPLORE • DISCOVER

Cotton has been an important crop in Alabama's history. Before it could be spun into thread and woven into cloth, the cotton fibers had to be separated from the seeds. In this activity, you will separate the cotton fibers from a cotton ball using your fingers or tweezers.

1 Start with a Cotton Ball

Look closely at your cotton ball. It is made of many soft fibers stuck together.



2 Pull Apart the Fibers

Use your fingers to gently pull and separate the cotton fibers. Be careful and pull slowly.



3 Use Tweezers (Optional)

Use tweezers to separate the fibers even more. See how long and thin the fibers can be!



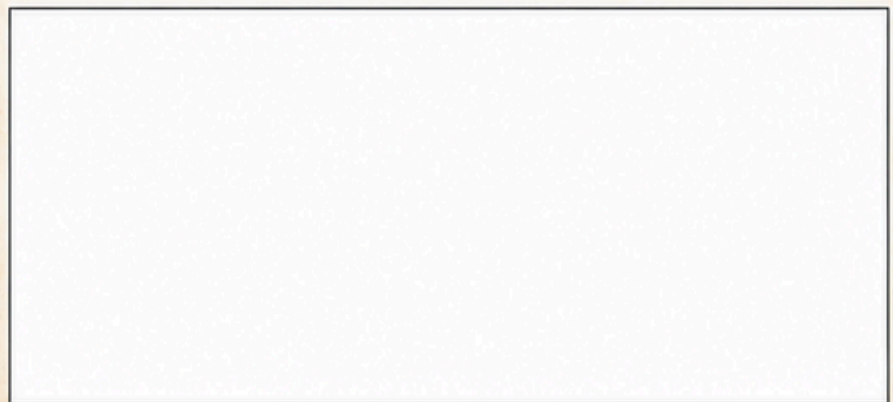
Materials:

- Cotton balls
- Tweezers (optional)
- A clean workspace



Observe and Draw

Look closely at your cotton fibers. What do they look like? Draw a picture of the fibers after you have separated them.



How do you think people separated cotton fibers long ago without modern tools?